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**A DH Approach to the Literary and Forensic Style of Three
Early French Translations of a Chinese Fiction Narrative**

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Introduction

Research Overview:

- We aim to isolate and describe key stylistic elements in a corpus of human translations of a single literary text.
- **Goal:** Identify stylistic traits unique to each translator of *Yu Jiao Li*, a mid-17th-century Chinese novel.
- **Focus:** Examine how linguistic choices reveal each translator's "thumbprint"—their unique stylistic imprint on the text.

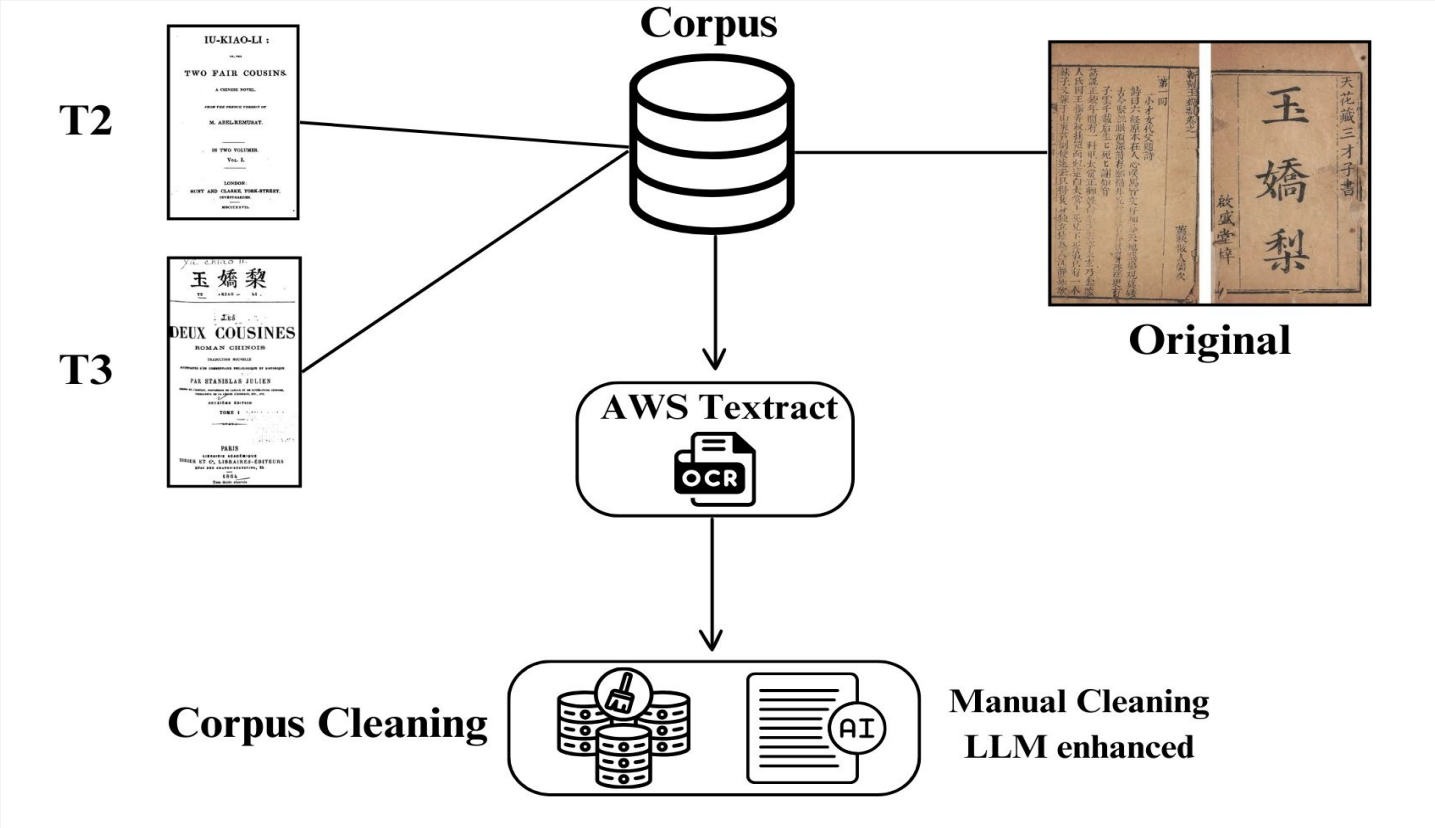
Significance of the Text Used:

- *Yu Jiao Li* introduced Chinese literature to European audiences, inspiring early ideas of "world literature" by demonstrating storytelling universal appeal.

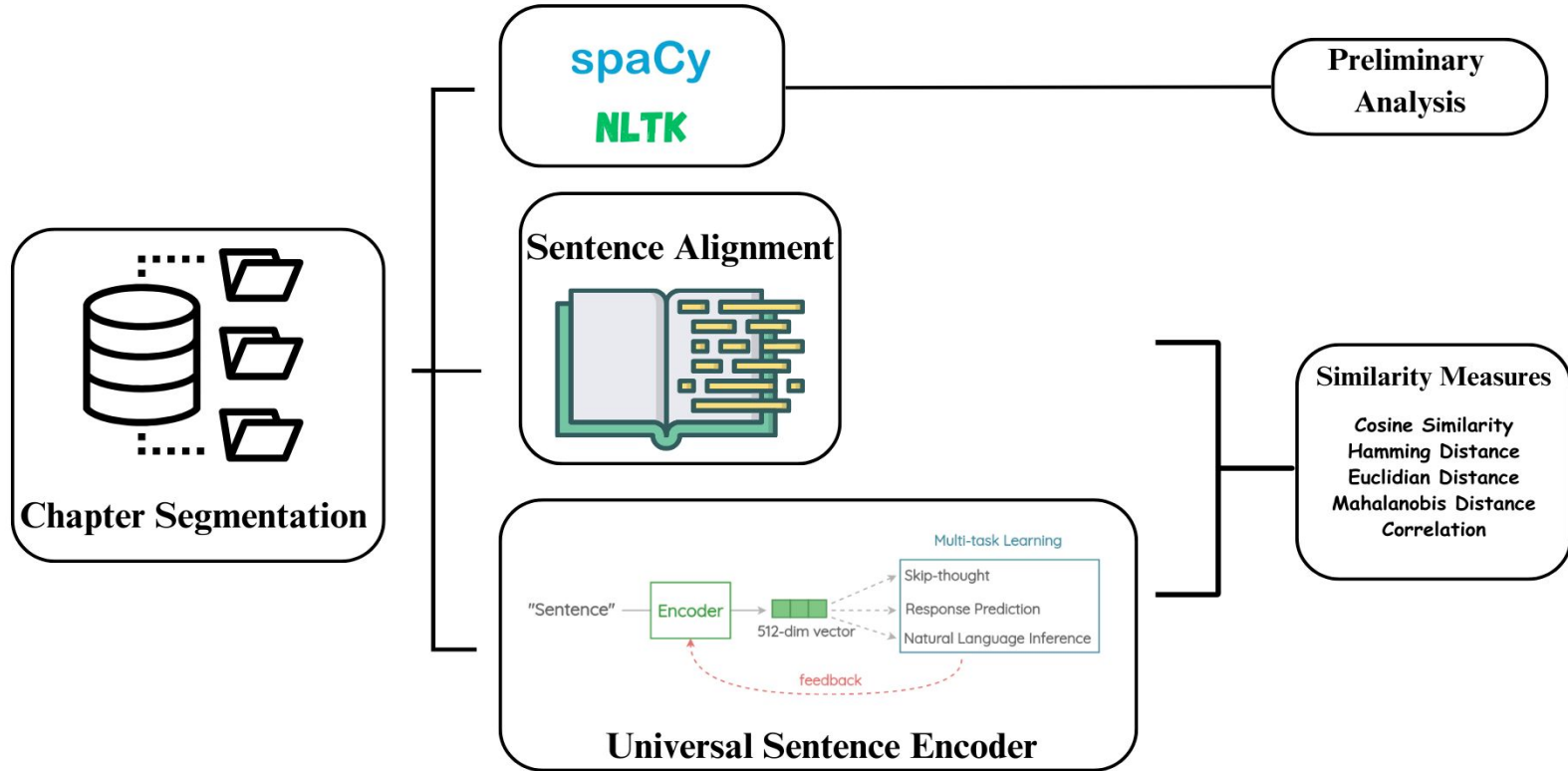
Foundation:

- Inspired by *Mona Baker's* theory that translators imprint a personal style on their translations.
- Builds on studies of stylistic variation in translated Chinese texts, such as *The Dream of the Red Chamber*.

Corpus Creation

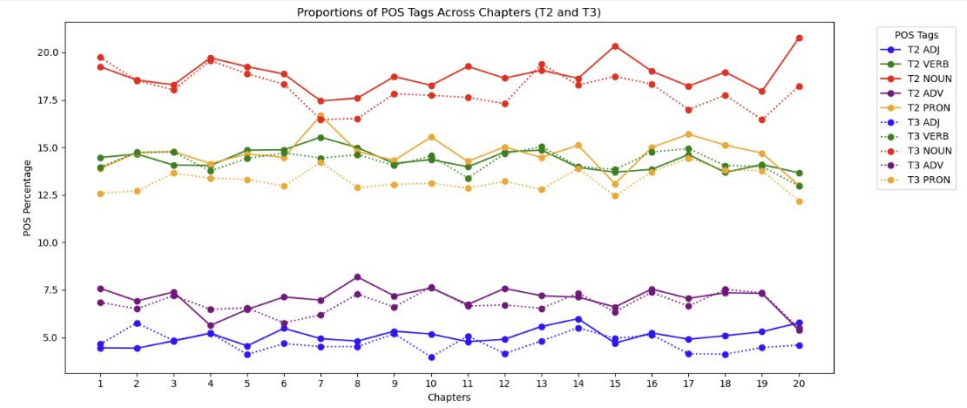


Methodology

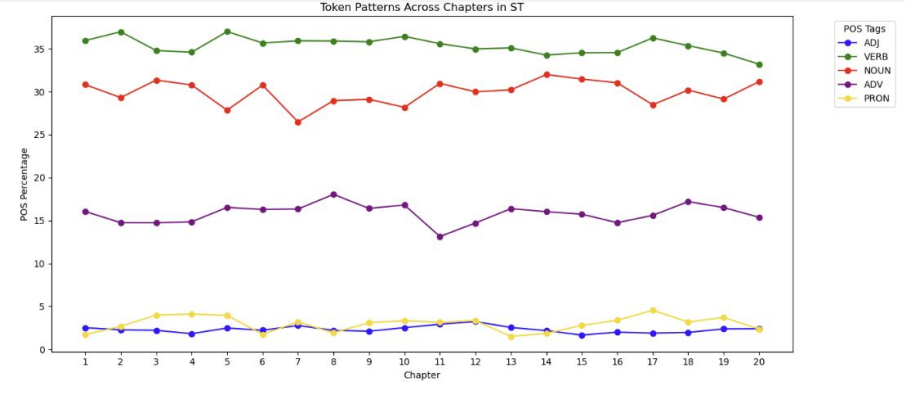


Preliminary Results

French Translation
Noun Heavy



Original Chinese
Verb Heavy



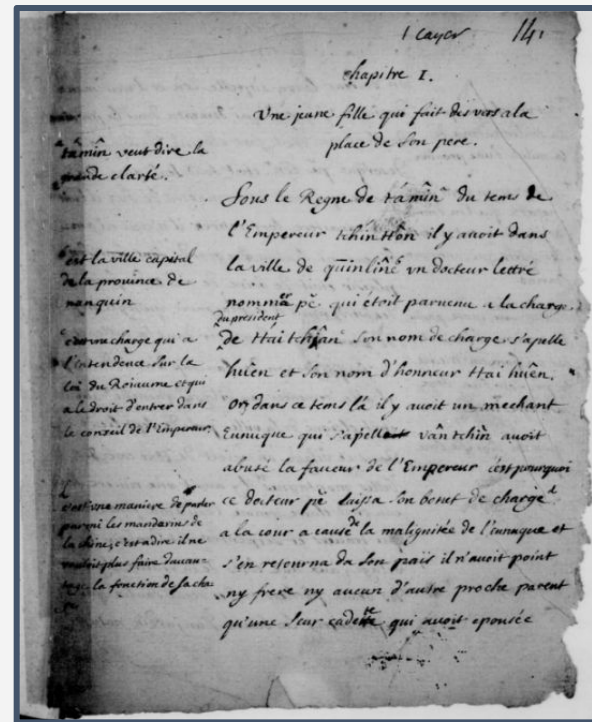
Challenges and future work

Challenges:

- Most of nlp toolkits are trained with modern languages.
- Extracting data from hand written translation.
- Isolating key markers to identify 'thumbprint' of the translator.
- Building/fine tuning/finding nlp based models to assist in classifying different translations or identifying key markers.

Future work:

- Compare vector similarities for all the chapters.
- Complete Machine translations in various styles (through prompt engineering).
- Create a larger corpora of text to have a better understanding of translatory styles of the 19th century.



References

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